

Product Manager Assessment Exam — Weekly Deployment Update Automation (n8n)

1) Overview

You are asked to design and build an automation that produces a **weekly deployment update** for stakeholders. The update must be generated from Jira (or realistic mock data if access is not available) and published to:

- A **Confluence page** in a **specific space**, using a required format
- A **weekly update slide** in a deck, using a required fixed layout

The update must clearly separate **Front End (FE)** and **Back End (BE)** deployments so both digital and non-digital stakeholders can scan quickly.

2) Instructions

- **Timebox:** 6–8 hours
- **Primary tool:** n8n
- If you do not have access to Jira/Confluence/Slides APIs, you may use mock data, but it must be:
 - Realistic (representative fields and volume)
 - Clearly documented (what is mocked vs real)
 - Demonstrated end-to-end in a reproducible way

3) Scenario / Business Context

Stakeholders want a consistent weekly update that answers:

- What was **deployed last week** ?
- What is **expected to deploy in the next 14 days**?
- What is the **team focusing on** and what is **at risk/blocked**?

We have a mix of **digital stakeholders** (care more about FE and site experiences) and **non-digital stakeholders** (care more about OMS/data/back-office). Splitting deployments into **FE vs BE** makes the weekly update immediately scannable.

4) Hard Requirements

4.1 Weekly Update Content (required sections + FE/BE categorization)

Your weekly update must contain the following sections, and the first two must be split into FE and BE:

A) Released / Deployed Last Week (must include FE + BE)

- **FE Releases (Deployed Last Week)**
 - Bullet list of FE items deployed in the defined “last week” window
 - Each bullet must include:
 - Ticket key (or unique ID)
 - Title/summary
 - Status
 - Link to Jira (or source system)
 - If none, display: “None”
- **BE Releases (Deployed Last Week)**
 - Same requirements as FE
 - If none, display: “None”

B) Upcoming Releases (Expected to Deploy in Next 14 Days) (must include FE + BE)

- **FE Releases (Expected Next 14 Days)**
 - Bullet list of FE items expected to deploy in the next 14 days
 - Each bullet must include:
 - Ticket key (or unique ID)
 - Title/summary
 - Status
 - Link to Jira (or source system)
 - Target date (if available)
 - If none, display: “None”
- **BE Releases (Expected Next 14 Days)**
 - Same requirements as FE
 - If none, display: “None”

C) Team Focus This Sprint (required)

- A concise list of the team's current sprint focus areas and significant workstreams
- Must be stakeholder-readable (short bullets, minimal jargon)
- Each bullet must include links to Jira epics/items where applicable

D) Risks / Blocks (required if any exist; otherwise explicitly say none)

- If there are known risks/blocks, list them (with links)
- If there are none, explicitly state: **"No known risks/blocks this week."**

4.2 FE vs BE classification (required)

Your workflow must categorize work items into **FE** vs **BE** using one or more of:

- Jira project key(s)
- Component(s)
- Label(s)
- Team field(s)
- Repo ownership mapping
- Assignee(s)

Rules:

- Classification logic must be **documented**
- If classification is not possible for an item, put it under **Uncategorized** (still include it, don't drop it)

4.3 Reporting windows (required)

Define and document the logic for:

A) "Deployed Last Week" window

- Example acceptable definition: last Monday 00:00 → Sunday 23:59 (timezone specified)
- Your solution must be consistent and explainable

B) "Expected Next 14 Days" window

- Forward-looking 14 calendar days from workflow execution time (timezone specified)

- Include the logic used to decide an item is “expected” (e.g., status, fixVersion/release field, target deploy date field, label, etc.)

4.4 Monday sprint planning adjustment + re-run behavior (required)

On Monday sprint planning, Engineering may adjust:

- the **expected deployments**, and/or
- what will actually **get to deployment** (priority changes, slips, scope cuts, etc.)

Requirements:

- Workflow auto-executes on Monday
- After sprint planning, the PM can **re-run** the workflow the same day to reflect the most up-to-date Jira state
- Re-running must **UPDATE** outputs (upsert) and **must not create duplicates**:
- **Confluence**: update/overwrite that week’s section (do not create a second weekly block)
- **Slide deck**: update/overwrite that week’s slide (do not create a second slide for the same week)
- “Expected Next 14 Days” must reflect the **latest plan** at the time of execution:
- Items removed from plan should no longer appear
- Newly added items should appear

5) Output Destinations (required)

5.1 Confluence output (required)

The workflow must publish the weekly update to a **Confluence page** in a **specific space**.

Confluence structure requirement

- The Confluence content must match the format shown in **Appendix A** (example screenshot):
- Title: **Week of Tech Update**
- Sections: Released Last Week, Upcoming Releases, Team Focus This Sprint, Risks/Blocks
- FE and BE subsections for Released Last Week and Upcoming Releases
- Must include a **Last updated** timestamp in the page content

Monthly page rollover requirement

- On the **first Monday of each month**, the Confluence output must start a **new monthly page**:
- Example title: **“2026 - January Tech Updates”**
- All weekly updates for that month must be appended into the same monthly page
- Each monthly page must live under the same Confluence space:
- Example space name: **“2026 Tech Updates”**
- When the month changes, create the new monthly page and begin appending there

Upsert requirement (Confluence)

- If the workflow runs multiple times in the same week (e.g., post-sprint planning re-run), it must update the existing weekly section, not duplicate it.

5.2 Slide deck output (required)

The workflow must also generate/update a weekly update slide using the fixed layout in **Appendix B**.

Slide layout requirement (fixed)

- Left: **Released Last Week**
- FE Released Last Week
- BE Released Last Week
- Right: **Upcoming Releases**
- FE Expected Next 14 Days (include dates if available)
- BE Expected Next 14 Days (include dates if available)
- Bottom/box section: **Focus**
- Key sprint focus bullets (short, stakeholder-readable)

Upsert requirement (Slide deck)

- Exactly **one slide per week**
- Re-runs must **update the existing slide** for the week, not add another slide

Deck location/link:

6) Data Source Requirements

Your automation must ingest work items from Jira (preferred) or realistic mock data.

Minimum required fields per item:

- Ticket key / unique ID
- Summary/title
- Status
- Last updated date
- URL link back to source
- A way to classify FE vs BE (component/label/project/etc.)

Nice-to-have fields (use if available):

- Target deploy date
- Fix version / release
- Epic/parent
- Assignee / team

Resilience requirement:

- Missing assignee/epic/target date must not break the workflow.

7) Deliverables

- **n8n workflow export JSON** (runnable)
- A short write-up (max 1 page) that includes:
 - Your reporting window definitions
 - Your FE/BE classification method
 - Your definition of “Deployed” and “Expected”
 - Edge cases handled
 - Assumptions (especially if mock data is used)
- Output proof:
 - Confluence page output
 - The slide

Appendix A — Confluence Format (Screenshot Template)

Format only. Uses placeholders (e.g., FE-1234, [Short title], [URL]).

Week of <Month DD, YYYY> Tech Update

Released Last Week

FE Releases:

- * [None] (if no FE deployments)
- [FE-1234] [Short title] — Link: [URL]
- [FE-5678] [Short title] — Link: [URL]

BE Releases:

- * [None] (if no BE deployments)
- [BE-2345] [Short title] — Link: [URL]
- [BE-6789] [Short title] — Link: [URL]

Upcoming Releases

FE Releases:

- * FE.<Release Version> - <Release Name> (Target: <Mon DD, YYYY>)
 - <Work item summary> - [FE-9012]
 - <Work item summary> - [FE-3456]

BE Releases:

- * [None]
- [BE-3456] [Short title] — Target: [YYYY-MM-DD] — Link: [URL]

Team Focus This Sprint

<Focus Area 1>

- [FE-1111] [Short title] (Status: [Ready for QA]) — Link: [URL]

<Focus Area 2>

- [BE-2222] [Short title] (Status: [Ready]) — Link: [URL]

<Focus Area 3>

- [BE-3333] [Short title] (Status: [To Do]) — Link: [URL]

Last updated: <YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM TZ>

Appendix B — Slide Format (Screenshot Template)

Format only. Uses placeholders (e.g., FE-1234, [Short title]).

Week of <Month DD, YYYY> Tech Update

Released Last Week

FE Release:

- [FE-1234] [Short title]
- [FE-5678] [Short title]
- None

BE Release:

- [BE-2345] [Short title]
- [BE-6789] [Short title]
- None

Upcoming Releases

FE Release — <Deploy Date>

- [FE-9012] [Short title]
- None

BE Release — <Deploy Date>

- [BE-3456] [Short title]
- None

Focus

- [Focus item 1]
- [Focus item 2]
- [Focus item 3]